

# Cambridge IGCSE™

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**FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH****0500/22**

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

**February/March 2026**

INSERT

**2 hours**

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**INFORMATION**

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



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This document has **4** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

### Text A

The following text is taken from an online blog about hobbies.

I've been surfing for almost 20 years now, but you wouldn't know it if you saw me. I'm the 30-something-year-old woman whooping like a kid when I manage to stand up on a wave.

Friends have insisted I take lessons, saying that I could improve if I trained harder. The implication is if I'm passionate about something, I should also be proficient. I say thanks, but I'm happy being a below-average surfer.

5

My career in medical sciences allows little room for error. Perfectionism and productivity have been drilled into me from a young age. Being busy, getting better, giving it 100 per cent, leads us to think that our precious spare time should be spent honing our skills or increasing our output; anything less is lazy.

Then there's the influence of people spurring us to 'monetise our hobbies'. While that can certainly be a great way to make some extra cash, the definition of a hobby is 'a pursuit engaged in for relaxation'. Introducing commercial pressures can kill that all-important 'relaxation' factor. Our downtime becomes just extra work time.

10

My hobbies are for imperfect pleasure. Psychologists have been highlighting the positive effects of hobbies on well-being for years; we get those essential happy hormones from losing ourselves in a chosen activity while being distracted from everyday stresses. I make clay earrings that often turn out mismatched or lumpy. Yet I still enjoy the process, the feeling of the clay between my fingertips and the pleasure of creating something uniquely mine. I'm lucky if my vegetable garden yields enough to make one salad every six months, but I still harvest portions of delight every time a new leaf unfurls or a flower blooms. It helps make up for other hobbies that aren't so environmentally friendly.

15

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A friend and I recently agreed to try a new activity every month, regardless of how good we'd be at it. This has led to some amusing adventures and to lots of hilarious videos on my social media of karting and of tai chi, for example. Judo struck a particular chord with her, and she's decided to persevere with it, but I'll keep giving new things a try for as long as my budget and all the resources in this wonderful city allow. Who cares if I'm the worst one there? The joy is in giving it a go and relishing a fresh experience.

25

**Text B**

The following text is an online blog on the concept of 'niksen time'.

As I hastily leapt from the sofa to answer the door, I flushed with embarrassment at the thought of my friend seeing me sitting motionless, staring into space. I had three assignments to complete in a week and books to read.

Now, I wonder why I was ashamed for having a brief rest during those intense early days of university in the big city. Our 'always on' culture makes even leisure time feel pressured and competitive.

5

I was bored and stressed at the same time, not just with my studies but with the endless activities I'd lined up for my 'free' time. Gym with friends, learning a musical instrument, building my own computer – it all seemed suddenly oppressive. It also ate into my meagre funds and my time.

10

It was around then that I came across the concept of 'niksen' – the Dutch term for consciously taking time to do nothing, just gazing out of the window or sitting still. No reading, no watching TV, no scrolling, nothing.

But the first time I tried nixsen, it was much harder than I anticipated. I found myself making a mental list of all the things I had to do. Trying to just be, to just sit quietly on the sofa was hard. I kept glancing at the clock on the wall to see how much longer I had left.

15

After some online nixsen tutorials, eventually I noticed an improvement. I looked at the trees outside, the shape and colour of the leaves. Instead of listening to music all the time, I've found silence. I'm going to take an advanced nixsen course as soon as I have the funds. I still have days when I can't make it work or I miss the laughs with my friends but it's worth the effort.

20

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## FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/22

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

February/March 2026

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

## INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:  
Section A: answer Question 1.  
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen. Do **not** use correction fluid or tape.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

## INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [ ].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

## Section A: Directed Writing

### Question 1

**Write an article** for young people about the best way for them to spend their leisure time.

In your article, you should:

- evaluate the attitudes in both texts about the purpose and value of leisure time
- give your advice about the factors young people should consider when deciding how to use their leisure time.

Base your article on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

**Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.**

[illegible]



3

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is defined by two parallel dotted lines, creating a series of uniform gaps for letter height. The entire page is otherwise blank, with no text or other markings.



[40]

[Total: 40]





Turn over

**Section B: Composition**

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

**Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.**

**Either**

**Descriptive writing**

**2** Describe people picking fruit or harvesting a crop.

**Or**

**Descriptive writing**

**3** Describe an object before and after it is cleaned.

**Or**

**Narrative writing**

**4** Write a story which involves a character learning to trust someone.

**Or**

**Narrative writing**

**5** Write a story with the title, 'A strange moment'.





Please write your chosen question number here (2, 3, 4, 5): .....

[illegible]

[illegible]





## This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.





## Additional page

If you use the following page to complete the answer to any question, the question number must be clearly shown.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting practice. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.



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